CSE0001 – Digital Literacy Project Report

Course: CSE0001 – Digital Literacy
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Branch: B.Tech Bioengineering
Year: First Year

Introduction

Through the Digital Literacy project I understood how technology is not only about using tools but also about using them responsibly and effectively. I explored multiple digital platforms that are useful for academic growth, professional development, communication, and cyber safety. From creating an infographic and building online profiles to drafting professional emails and researching cybercrime, each task gave practical exposure to real-world digital skills. The project also showed how digital habits influence our academic and professional image. Overall, this assignment improved my confidence in using online tools while also making me more aware of digital responsibility, professionalism, and safe online behavior.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I used Canva to design a one-page infographic on digital literacy awareness. My infographic covered three main topics: the meaning of digital literacy, safe internet practices, and professional online presence. I selected Canva because it provides ready-made templates, icons, and layouts that make visual communication easier for beginners. The design included simple icons, short explanations, and color-coded sections so that students could quickly understand the concepts.

One interesting thing I observed while making the infographic was how strongly design influences understanding. A well-organized visual made the information look more engaging and easier to remember. At the same time, I realized that using ready-made elements without understanding design principles can create only surface-level quality. The most difficult part was choosing the right balance between attractive visuals and meaningful content. This task helped me understand that digital literacy is not just about presenting information but also about ensuring that the message is clear, accurate, and responsible.

WHAT IS DIGITAL LITERACY?

VATSALA DAS
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Useful Digital Tools for Students

- Productivity & Organization (Calendar, Task Managers)
- Collaboration Platforms (Documen Sharing, Video Conferencing)
Your paragraph text
- Research & Information Gathering (Search Engines, Online Libraries)

Safe Internet Practices

- Strong Passwords & Two-Factor Authentication
- Identifying Phishing & Scams (Email, Links)
- Managing Privacy Settings (Social Media, Accounts)

Professional Online Presence

- Creating a Professional Profile (LinkedIn, Portfolio)
- Curating Online Content (Thoughtful Sharing)
- Networking & Communication (Email Etiquette, Online Groups)

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

In this task, I created or updated my profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. I chose these three platforms because each serves a different professional purpose. GitHub is useful for storing and showcasing coding projects, LinkedIn helps build a professional network and academic identity, and Kaggle introduces students to data science and practical problem-solving.

On GitHub, I created a profile README that includes my name, branch, year, and my learning goals. On LinkedIn, I completed my education details with my current degree and university. Kaggle gave me exposure to how students can participate in beginner-level datasets and challenges. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to document projects, LinkedIn to build my professional network, and Kaggle to strengthen my analytical and technical skills.

This task taught me that digital presence should focus on authenticity rather than exaggeration. A simple and genuine profile can create better long-term opportunities than a profile built only for appearance.

vatsala25boe10123-cmd / vatsala25boe10123

Code | Issues | Pull requests | Actions | Projects | Wiki | Security | Insights | Settings

main | vatsala25boe10123 / README.md | Go to file

vatsala25boe10123-cmd Update README.md aae4b0f · now

5 lines (4 loc) · 109 Bytes

Preview | Code | Blame | Raw

vatsala25boe10123

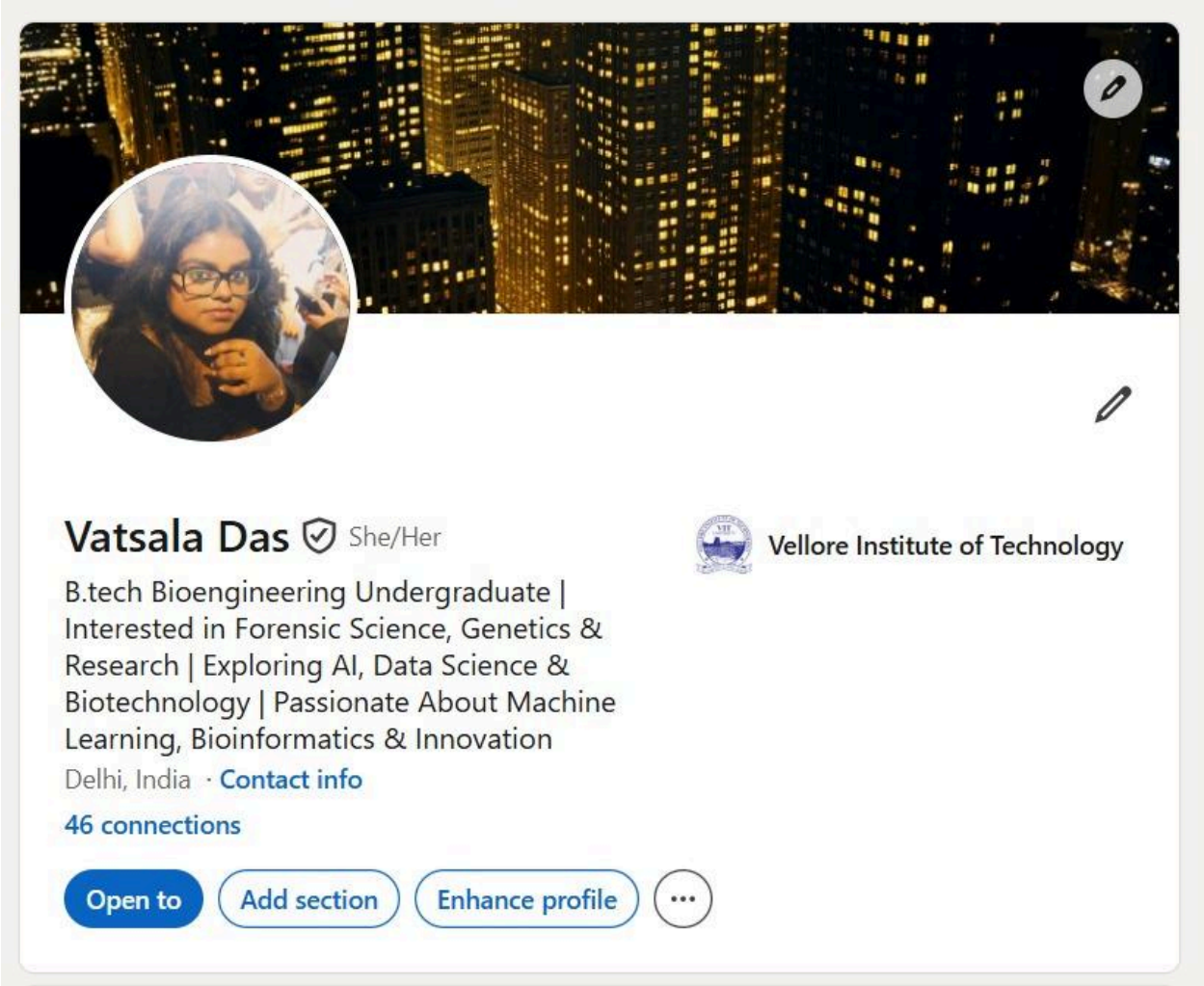
hi, I am vatsala das. I am a B.TECH student. I want to learn coding and digital skills.

vatsaladas25boe10123

VATSALA DAS 25BOE10123

Joined 25 seconds ago · last seen in the past day

About



Task 3 – Platforms

For this task, I used HackerRank for coding practice and Google Forms for collaboration tools. On HackerRank, I completed a beginner-level challenge, which helped me understand how coding platforms improve logical thinking and problem-solving. It also introduced me to the importance of regular practice and skill-based learning.

For the collaboration part, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms with five questions, including multiple-choice and short-answer types. I linked the responses to Google Sheets to

observe how data collection and response management work in real time. This task showed me how digital collaboration tools can be used not only for assignments but also for surveys, feedback, and academic teamwork.

The most valuable learning from this task was that digital platforms can make academic work more interactive and efficient. However, their effectiveness depends on how responsibly students use them.

Insights

Average	Median	Range
0 / 0 points	0 / 0 points	0 - 0 points

Total points distribution

what does "phishing" mean in the context of internet safety?

Copy chart

1 response

- a technique to speed up your internet connection
- a method of compressing large files online
- a fraudulent attempt to steal personal information by pretending to be a trustworthy source

Which of the following is the best way to verify if an online news article is credible?

Copy chart

1 response

- believe it if a friend shared it
- cross check the information with multiple trusted sources
- look at how well designed the website is.

What does "two-factor authentication (2FA)" do?

Copy chart

1 response

- doubles your internet speed
- adds an extra layer of security by requiring a second form
- creates two copies of your password

Which of the following is an example of plagiarism in the digital world?

Copy chart

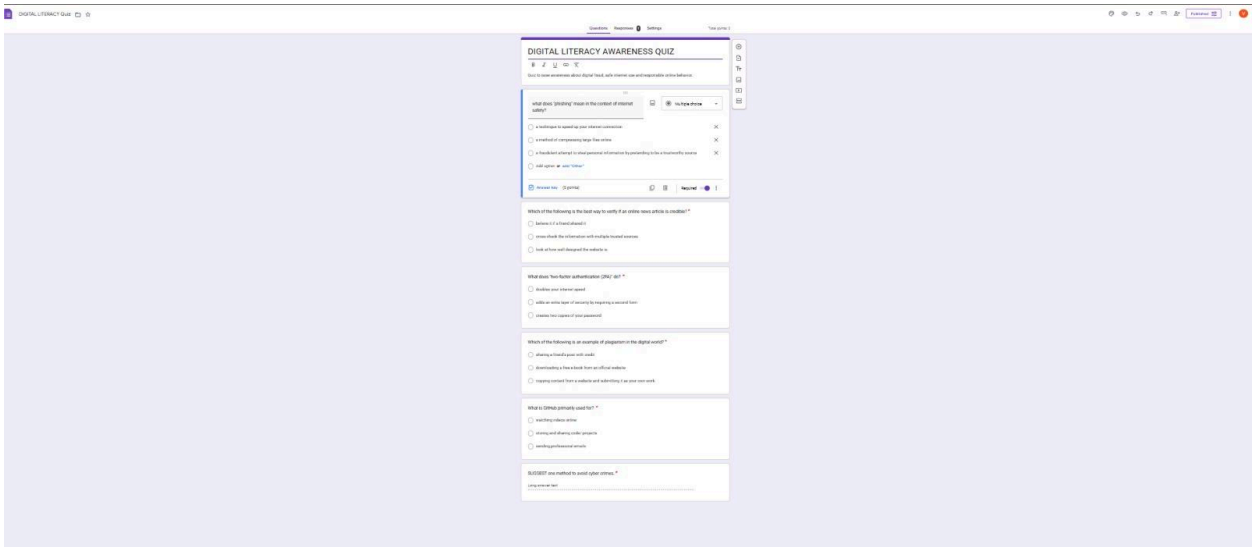
1 response

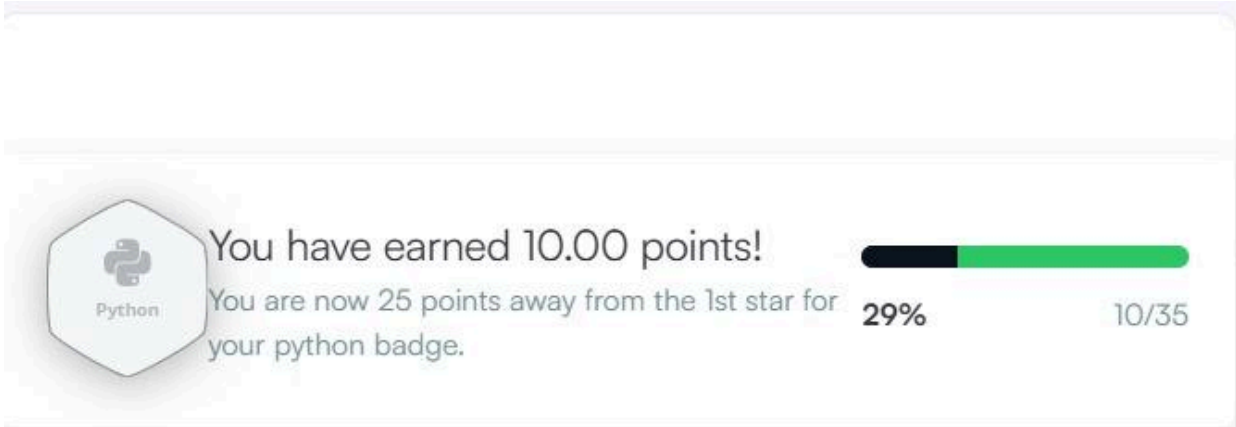
- sharing a friend's post with credit
- downloading a free e-book from an official website
- copying content from a website and submitting it as your own work

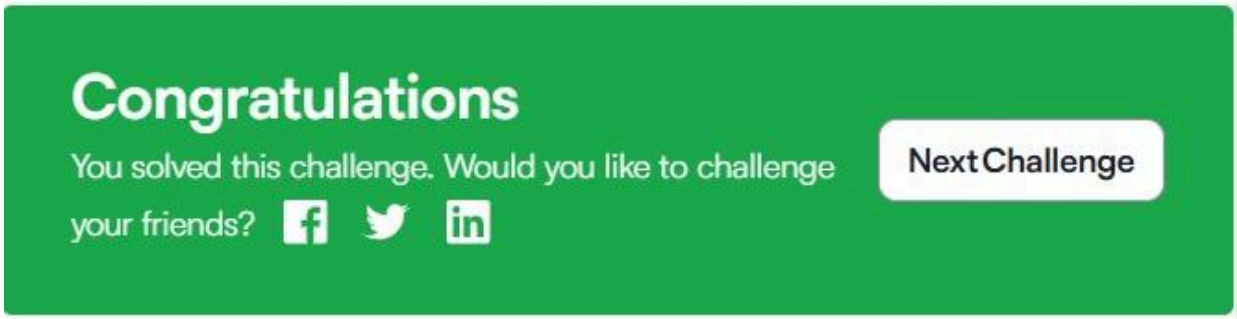
What is GitHub primarily used for?

Copy chart

1 response


DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS QUIZ


Python
You have earned 10.00 points!
You are now 25 points away from the 1st star for your python badge.
29%
10/35


Congratulations
You solved this challenge. Would you like to challenge your friends?
Next Challenge

Test case 0
Test case 1
Compiler Message
Success

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette

This task focused on professional communication. I drafted two emails: one requesting an assignment extension from a professor and another expressing interest in a summer internship. While writing these emails, I learned that digital communication is not only about sharing information but also about tone, respect, and structure.

A common problem among students is carrying casual chat habits into formal emails. For example, a short message like “Send recommendation ASAP” may sound rude even if the request is genuine. A better approach is to include a clear subject line, respectful greeting, proper explanation, and professional sign-off.

I also created a social media do’s and don’ts checklist, which emphasized responsible posting, privacy, and respectful online behavior. This task taught me that professionalism in communication directly affects perception, opportunities, and credibility.

Task 5– Cybercrime Awareness

For this task, I researched UPI and online payment fraud, which is one of the most common cyber threats faced by students in India. I created a case study explaining how scammers use urgency, fake payment links, and QR codes to trick users into entering their UPI PIN. I also prepared a prevention checklist that included tips such as never sharing OTPs, verifying QR codes, and reporting fraud immediately to **1930** or the National Cyber Crime Portal.

What surprised me most was how such simple tricks can lead to serious financial loss. Many people still believe that entering a UPI PIN is necessary to receive money, which scammers misuse. The one

habit I will personally change is verifying every financial request before taking action, especially when urgency is involved.

This task helped me understand that cyber safety depends on both awareness and behavior. Knowing risks is important, but consistently applying safe habits is what truly prevents fraud.

Conclusion

This Digital Literacy project gave me practical exposure to the most important digital skills required in academic and professional life. It improved my understanding of visual communication, professional identity, collaboration tools, email etiquette, and cyber awareness. More importantly, it helped me realize that digital literacy is not just technical usage but also ethical, professional, and responsible decision-making. I now feel more confident in using online platforms for learning and career growth, while also being more aware of digital safety and professionalism.